

What data professionals told us

**About work,
pay, and
getting in.**

A survey-led snapshot of the field,
its signals, and its uncertainty.

THE RESPONDENT FIELD

630 responses reveal a young, globally distributed field

630

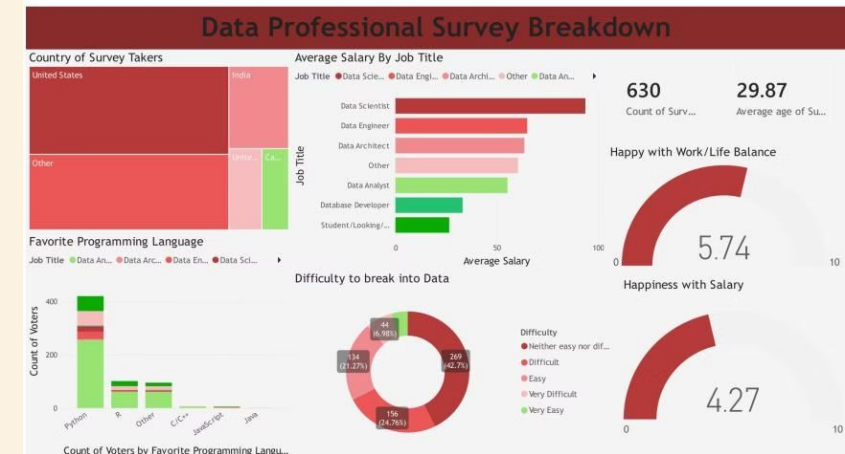
respondents

29.87

average age

Geography

The United States is a prominent respondent group, with India and other countries also represented.

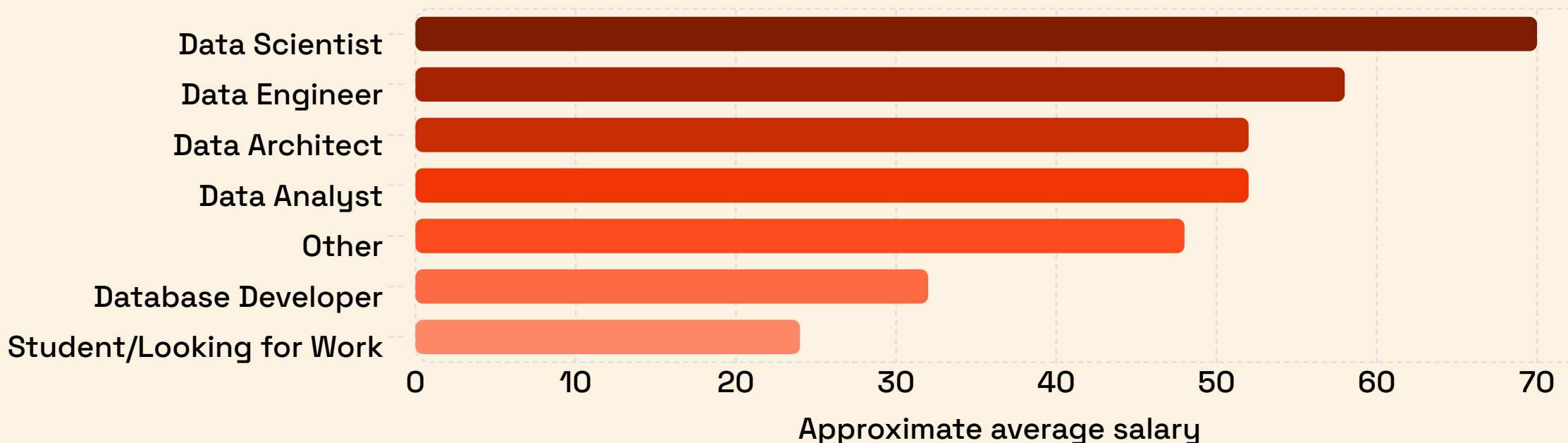


PAY SIGNAL

Data Scientist is the highest-paid role shown

Approximate average salary by job title. The displayed ordering places Data Scientist first, followed by Data Engineer and Data Architect; Data Analyst, Database Developer, and Student/Looking for Work appear lower.

Job title



Salary values are approximate where the dashboard export is not clearly readable.

Python is the clear favorite language

Python

Lead

Largest respondent count in the chart.

R

Next

Second in the displayed chart.

Other

Third

Follows R in the displayed chart.

C/C++

Smaller in the displayed chart.

JavaScript

Smaller in the displayed chart.

Java

Smaller in the displayed chart.

EXPERIENCE SIGNAL

People feel better about balance than pay

5.74

Work-life
balance

out of 10

4.27

Salary
satisfaction

out of 10

1.47

The gap

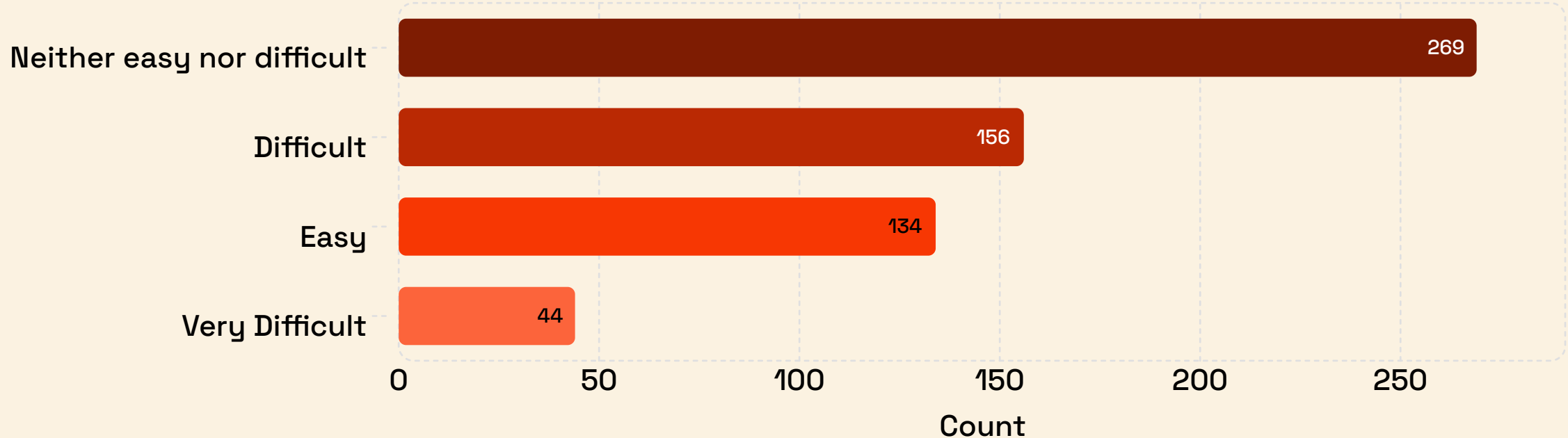
Salary satisfaction trails
work-life balance by 1.47
points.

ENTRY POINT

Breaking into data feels uncertain for many

The largest group chose “Neither easy nor difficult,” while roughly one quarter chose “Difficult.”

Response



Percentages in the dashboard: 42.7%, 24.76%, 21.27%, and 6.98%, respectively.

HOW TO READ THE FINDINGS

The dashboard is a useful starting point, not the final answer

Frame the roles

Use role comparisons to frame career research, then validate salary figures with current market data.

Start with Python

Use Python as a practical starting point while building role-specific skills.

Segment the gap

Segment satisfaction by role, country, and experience to understand what drives the gap.

Training can target the uncertainty at the entry point



Make the transition practical

Offer practical projects, mentoring, and job-readiness support for people navigating the transition.



Investigate the uncertainty

Investigate why a large share of respondents experience entry as neither easy nor difficult.



Keep the scope clear

Keep the findings scoped to survey respondents; the dashboard does not establish causation.

CARRY FORWARD

Three signals to carry forward

CAREER PATH

Data Scientist

Leads the displayed salary ordering.

SKILL SIGNAL

Python

Is the most selected language.

EXPERIENCE SIGNAL

Balance over pay

People report more satisfaction with balance than with salary.